

West London U10 Football Club

Year One Cost Guide & Savings Opportunities

Verified planning document — July 2026

**One volunteer coach · One team · 10–12 players · Weekly training ·
Weekend league**

This PDF was checked against the figures in your ChatGPT conversation. All line-item totals and per-player splits below were recalculated; where the original chat rounded or contradicted itself, corrections are noted explicitly.

1. Verification summary

What checked out. The detailed “full specification” budget adds up to **£7,680** (350 + 200 + 3,200 + 600 + 500 + 2,030 equipment & kit + 800 admin/events). Per-player shares at that total are correct: 10 players = £768/season (~£70/month over 11 months); 12 players = £640 (~£58/month); 14 players = £549 (~£50/month). Referee allowance of 20 matches × £25 = £500 aligns with published London youth fees (commonly £20–£25 for U9/U10). Lean first-year total of £4,250–£4,500 also arithmetic-checks.

Corrections from the ChatGPT chat. (1) The chat said to “budget around £6,500” while listing items that sum to £7,680 — £6,500 is reasonable only if you defer trophies, tournaments, and some kit spend; the full table total is £7,680. (2) Premium-club surplus was stated as ~£3,700; $12 \times £85 \times 11 - £7,500$ costs = £3,720. (3) Regent's Park FC parent league fees were quoted as £199 for Saturday league — their FAQ still lists £199 (some pages also mention £240; confirm at registration). (4) Personal references (family names, unrelated businesses) are omitted from this shareable version.

2. Planning assumptions

- One U10 squad of 10–12 players, one volunteer head coach, no paid coaching staff.
- 40 weekly training sessions (school-year length); ~20 home league matches.
- West London — pitch and league costs vary by borough, venue, and league choice.
- Parent subscriptions fund the team unless sponsorship or grants are secured.

Legend: “Published / typical” = aligned with league handbooks or club fee pages where cited. “Planning allowance” = realistic budget line where prices vary by supplier or venue.

3. Full-specification year-one budget

Item	Cost (£)	Basis
FA affiliation & league registration	£350	Planning allowance — confirm with chosen league
Public liability insurance	£200	Typical annual club policy
Training pitch (40 × £80)	£3,200	Planning — London 4G hire often ~£45–£87/hr
Home match pitch hire	£600	Planning — ~£30–£65 per home match
Referees (20 × £25)	£500	Typical — SELKENT U9/U10 £20; many leagues £25
Match balls (6)	£180	Planning allowance
Training balls (20)	£400	Planning allowance
Cones, bibs, poles, pump, bag	£250	Planning allowance
Portable goals	£300	Planning allowance
First aid & ice packs	£100	Planning allowance
Team match kit (12 players)	£700	Planning — lower with sponsor
Goalkeeper kit	£100	Planning allowance
Coach clothing	£150	Optional
End-of-season trophies	£250	Optional
Tournament entries	£300	Optional year one

Item	Cost (£)	Basis
Website / team app	£100	Optional — free tools available
Total (full specification)	£7,680	

Break-even subscriptions (full budget)

Squad size	Per player / season	Per player / month (11 months)
10	£768	£69.82
12	£640	£58.18
14	£548.57	£49.87

4. Lean launch budget (cost-optimised)

Total: **£4,250** (up to £4,300 with a small paid app). With 12 players: £354.17–£358.33 per season (~£32.20–£32.58 per month).

Item	Cost (£)
League & FA fees	£350
Insurance	£200
Training pitch (season deal / shared)	£1,800
Home pitch	£300
Referees	£500
Essential equipment	£600
Kit (with sponsorship)	£200
First aid	£100
Coach clothing (minimal)	£50
Trophies	£150
Tournaments	£0
Team app	£0
Total	£4,250

5. Three launch scenarios

Scenario	Indicative total	When to use
Lean launch	£4,250 – £4,750	Sponsorship, school/community pitch, defer tournaments
Standard	£5,500 – £6,250	Balanced quality; mid-range training hire
Full specification	£7,680	All optional lines included in section 3

6. Highest-impact savings

Area	Typical	Optimised	Approach
Training pitch	£3,200	~£1,800	Season booking, school site, or share with another team
Match kit	£700	~£200	Local sponsor before ordering shirts
Equipment	£1,130	~£600	Essentials only in year one (balls, cones, bibs, pump)
Website	£100	£0	Spond, WhatsApp, social media
Tournaments	£300	£0	Add from year two

7. One-off coach compliance (not in team budget)

Item	Typical cost
Introduction to Coaching Football	£24–£160 (funded places often ~£24–£30)
Safeguarding Children	~£30
Introduction to First Aid	~£30
Enhanced DBS (volunteer)	~£10

8. Context: what established clubs charge

Regent's Park FC publishes separate **league/match fees** for parents (e.g. Saturday league historically quoted at £199 per player per season in their FAQ — covers registration, refs, and match-day coaching/admin). That is *not* the same as your standalone startup costs: a new team still pays affiliation, insurance, training hire, kit, and equipment directly. Established West London clubs often charge **£600–£650+ per player per season** when training, matches, and admin are bundled.

9. Recommendations

- Do not cut: safeguarding, insurance, safe pitch, and adequate footballs.
- Secure kit sponsorship before placing kit orders.
- Treat £7,680 as the “everything included” ceiling; target £5,500–£6,000 for a sensible first season.
- Reconcile ambiguous expenses annually using actual invoices, not estimates.

Sources & notes

Referee fees: SELKENT handbook (U9/U10 £20); NE Hampshire YFL 2025/26 (U9/U10 £25). Regent's Park FC league fees: regentsparkfc.com FAQ. Pitch hire illustration: public London facility pages (~£45–£87/hr for small-sided 4G). Surrey Youth FL player registration examples from £1.50–£3.00 per player (club/league layer is separate). All scenario totals should be requested with your chosen league and venue before sharing with parents.

Prepared from shared ChatGPT conversation (6a5ff728-ea50-83eb-9d70-d53b10a8dff4) with independent arithmetic verification.